

Comparative Protease Activity Across Koji-Mold Strains and Its Effect on Amino Acid Content

Sato et al. (2023, fictional)

1. Introduction

The protease activity produced by koji mold is a key factor directly tied to a sake's amino acid content and perceived umami intensity. This study compares protease activity across different koji-mold strains and evaluates the effect on amino acid content.

2. Materials and methods

Three strains of yellow koji mold (Strain A, Strain B, and Strain C) were used to produce koji under identical conditions, and protease activity was measured. The resulting koji was used in small-scale trial brews, and the amino acid content of the moromi was analyzed after pressing.